

Five Steps to Financial Wellbeing

several visits to the supermarket where our debit card was declined. How upset and embarrassed my mum was, the second-hand shame that I felt – and would go on to feel first-hand when the same thing happened to me a few years later. It's an odd phenomenon, the way that sometimes we recoil from our parents' mistakes, marching resolutely in the opposite direction, and sometimes we seem destined to repeat them. Our brains don't always seem to take the most logical route, and understanding how our past shapes our current attitude to money can take a little more unpacking – but it's important that we try to unravel this thread and unearth these experiences that could be holding us back or keeping us locked in a mindset that's preventing us from achieving a sense of financial wellbeing.

I spoke to Lydia,* who has linked what she describes as a hatred of money to feeling unworthy as a child. 'I have worked out that my overspending is really a wish to get rid of money in my account, like it's "dirty",' she says. 'My Dad used to "buy our love" with money and gifts that we didn't want. I hated money as a child, and I hate it now – how it makes me feel, how people act around it and how people use it as a power play. I'm now trying to work through this with my therapist.'

How our relationship with money can change throughout our lives, and in response to our relationships, is something that is

* I have changed all names to preserve anonymity.